

TEXT OF THE REMARKS BY
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(*K'ayayen Sarkin Musulmi, Wakilin Maganin Zazzau, Iyan Piriga*)
THE PRO-CHANCELLOR AND CHAIRMAN OF THE GOVERNING COUNCIL,
IGBINEDION UNIVERSITY, OKADA (IUO), OKADA, EDO STATE
PRESENTED TO MEMBERS OF THE GOVERNING COUNCIL OF THE UNIVERSITY
ON THE OCCASION OF THE 90TH REGULAR MEETING OF THE COUNCIL
ON FRIDAY, 13TH MARCH, 2026
AT OTI HOTEL, SAPELE ROAD, BENIN CITY

Protocol, and Happy New Year.

It is my pleasure to welcome His Excellency, Chief Lucky Igbinedion, the Deputy Chancellor of our great University; members of the Governing Council; and the Principal Officers of the University to the 90th Regular Meeting of the 7th Council of Igbinedion University, Okada.

At this stage, let me congratulate members who are observing the Lenten and Ramadan fasts, two major religious events for Christians and Muslims that are ongoing concurrently. We shall continue to pray, as usual, for Almighty God to grant our Chancellor, His Excellency Sir Gabriel Igbinedion, *CFR*, the Esama of Benin Kingdom, longer life, excellent health, and happiness; and for the University, under the Vice-Chancellor, Professor Lawrence Ezemonye, *FAS*, rapid growth in leaps and bounds, as well as continued excellence as the Premier Private University in Nigeria.

As a Council, our oversight function over the University is to ensure that the over 90 programmes offered by the University continue to excel and maintain the high standards set by the various accreditation bodies, whether those constituted by the National Universities Commission (NUC) or those established by the recognised and approved professional regulatory councils.

At the same time, our products, our alumni, who serve as ambassadors of the University, having excelled in character and learning, must continue to uphold the good name of the University in high esteem. This is evident in their contributions in their various workplaces, in their chosen careers, or in the management of their businesses. Between these two (2) extremes lies the

intense effort by the Council, in tandem with the Management of the University, to persevere and walk the tightrope until success is continuously achieved.

I am sure that members are eager to receive updates in respect of the two ad hoc committees which we established in an attempt to refine the Roadmap of the University and redirect its trajectory, albeit within the strategic plans earlier set for greater effectiveness and efficiency.

Engineer Greg, as we affectionately refer to Engr. Greg Ogbeifun, fresh from celebrating his 75th birthday, certainly has much to brief us on. Once again, congratulations to our dear Engineer. Professor Chinedum Peace Babalola, my sister and professional colleague, is eagerly awaiting our comments on the excellent and robust report of her Committee, which was distributed to members during the 89th Regular Meeting at the Permanent Site, Okada.

There is also a Memo titled: *IUO Okada Communication Strategy*, to be presented by Mr. Frank Nweke II. Members will recall that at the 89th Council Meeting, this Council approved the setting up of its third ad hoc Committee, the Committee on Communication Strategy for the University, with Mr. Frank Nweke II as its Chairman.

As usual, Council will be briefed by the Vice-Chancellor on the affairs of the University from November 2025, when we last met as a Council, to this month. Of course, we are all aware that the Vice-Chancellor will be celebrating his birthday tomorrow—the second of the landmark birthdays among members this year.

Finally, I wish members a successful meeting, just as I look forward to commencing the birthday celebration of our Vice-Chancellor with the dinner tonight.

Thank you very much for your attention and for listening, and God bless.